Revision:
09/01/2026

Background:
Changes reported during the certification period that occur outside of the Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7) or recertification (RE) process are considered mid-period reports. This policy outlines the categories of mid-period reports and the corresponding actions required.

Purpose:
This section has been revised to implement policy changes and procedures for processing voluntary mid-period reports. CalFresh Program Guide (CFPG) Sections 63-284, 63-285, 63-286 and Processing Guide 283-01 are now obsolete. The following updates for mid-period reports have been incorporated into this section:

- Guidance on actions to take when a change will result in an increase, decrease, or no change of benefits.
- Verification requirements for voluntary income changes.
- New guidance on when to issue supplemental payments and re-evaluation of benefit allotments.

Policy:
Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) HHs are informed of their mandatory reporting responsibilities via the Reporting Changes for Cash Aid and CalFresh (SAR 2) informing notice. The SAR 2 is issued when a case is initially approved, and when the Income Reporting Threshold (IRT) changes during the certification period. For Elderly Simplified Application Project (ESAP) HHs, the SAR 2 is sent on the 12th and 24th month of the certification period as a reminder of the ESAP HH's reporting requirements.

The SAR 2 informs the HH of the following:

- The HH's size, current gross monthly income, and IRT amount.
- How to report when gross monthly income exceeds the IRT and the 10-day reporting requirement.
- What will happen when mandatory changes are reported.
- The potential consequences for not reporting income exceeding IRT.
- Voluntarily reporting information.
- For HHs with an Able-Bodied Adult Without Dependent (ABAWD), to report when work or training hours drop to less than 20 hours a week or 80 hours a month.

Mid-period reports are categorized as mandatory, voluntary, and county-initiated. The required action for mid-period reports is dependent on the category, reporting requirements, and impact to the HH's benefits. Mid-period reports may be made in writing, online, verbally, or in person. The following forms must be made available for HHs to report mid-period changes in writing at initial application, RE, or upon request:

- Mid-Period Status Report for Cash Aid and CalFresh (SAR 3).
- CalFresh Mid-Certification Period Status Report (CF 377.5 SAR).

1. CalFresh Mandatory Mid-Period Reports

SAR HHs must report the following mandatory changes within 10 days of the date the HH becomes aware of the change:

- The HH's gross income exceeds their CalFresh IRT.

- An ABAWD's work or training hours drop below an average of 20 hours per week or 80 hours a month.
- The HH receives substantial lottery or gambling winnings that is equal to or greater than the resource limit for Elderly or Disabled (E/D) HHs.

Take the appropriate action on mandatory reports, regardless of the impact to the HH's benefits.
Refer to the following CFPG sections for further information:
- 63-125 Income Reporting Threshold (IRT).
- 63-247 Substantial Lottery or Gambling Winnings.
- 63-904 Able-Bodied Adults Without Dependents Time Limit.

2. Decrease in Benefits:

When a SAR HH reports a change during the certification period, it is a mid-period report. Action on mid-period reports must not be taken if the information received decreases or terminates the HH's benefits unless one of the following applies:
- The HH voluntarily requests benefit termination.
- The information received is Verified Upon Receipt (VUR).
- A HH member has been identified as a fleeing felon or parole violator.
- There is a change in the Public Assistance (PA) grant.
- County-initiated mid period changes.
- The information received is a mandatory mid-period report.

With the exception of the items above, do not request verification of reported changes that result in a decrease or no change in benefits. Document the change being reported by the HH in the case record, the reason for not acting on the change, and send a No-Change Notice of Action (NOA). The NOA must remind the HH to report the information at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first. Action must be taken at the next SAR 7 or RE, regardless of the impact on benefits.

See examples below of reported changes that result in a decrease in benefits.

Example 1	
Scenario	HH reports an income increase but is under IRT, and the change will result in a decrease in benefits.
Outcome	Do not request verification. Send a No-Change NOA. Document the change in case record and follow up at next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.
Example 2	
Scenario	HH voluntarily reports a change in HH composition, to add a person that will result in a decrease in benefits.
Outcome	Do not request verification of the new members' income or other mandatory verifications. Send a No-Change NOA. Document the change in case record and follow up at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

Note: Proper documentation used in the eligibility determination and benefit level must be clearly included in the case record to support changes reported mid-period, even when no action is taken on

the case. Documentation must be in sufficient detail to determine the reasonableness and accuracy of the determination.

3. County-Initiated Mid-Period Changes

County-initiated changes include mass changes and information known to the county. Action must be taken on all county-initiated changes regardless of the impact on the HH's benefits. The following are considered county-initiated changes and require mid-period action:

- HH is approved for PA benefits including California Work Opportunity and Responsibility to Kids (CalWORKs), Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants (CAPI), Supplemental Security Income/State Supplementary Payment (SSI/SSP), Tribal Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF), and General Relief.
- Failure of a HH member to comply with a Quality Control (QC) review.
- Verified Nationwide Prisoner Match (NPM) or Deceased Person Match (DPM).
- Verified information that the HH is receiving benefits in another state.
- Cost-of-Living Adjustment (COLA).
- Individuals subject to the ABAWD time limit, whose three-month time limit ended or an ABAWD who regained eligibility and stopped meeting the work requirement.

4. VUR

VUR is information that is clear, consistent, complete and does not require additional verification from the HH. For information to be considered VUR, it must meet all the following criteria:

VUR Criteria	Definition
Complete	The information has all the components necessary to take action.
Not questionable	There are no discrepant elements to the information that would cast doubt on its accuracy, completeness or timeliness.
Requires no further verification	Action can be taken without needing any further verification.
Obtained from the primary source	The primary source is a first-hand direct source that has complete knowledge and accurate information about the circumstance.

Information considered VUR may become known to the county through a voluntary report, mandatory report, electronic source, or another means. When information is received that is considered VUR, it must be acted on, regardless of the impact on the HH's benefits. Exceptions to this are HH composition and voluntary income changes not over IRT that would result in a decrease in benefits.

VUR is limited to the following:

- A voluntary report made by the HH of a:
  - HH composition change.
  - Change of address.
- A Payment Verification System (PVS) report. The PVS report may contain:
  - Retirement, Survivors and Disability Insurance (RSDI) data from the Social Security Administration (SSA).
  - State Unemployment Insurance Benefits (UIB) from the Employment Development Department (EDD).
  - State Disability Insurance (SDI) from the EDD.

- Social Security and SSI and/or SSP benefit information obtained from the SSA.
  - Benefit information obtained from SSA is considered reported and verified on the day the information is first known to the county through any of the following automated data exchanges: Income and Eligibility Verification System (IEVS), or the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS) "Title XVI – SSI/SSP Information" INQX screen.
- UIB and SDI benefit information reported through IEVS and obtained from the California EDD.
  - UIB/SDI information is considered reported and verified on the date of the IEVS notification.
- Worker's Compensation benefits obtained from the California Worker's Compensation agency.
- A California Intentional Program Violation (IPV) report.
  - The IPV must be established to disqualify a HH member.
- PA benefit amount information.
  - PA benefit amount is considered reported and verified on the date the PA benefit amount is authorized.
- Non-citizen status obtained from the Systemic Alien Verification for Entitlements (SAVE) system.
- In-Home Supportive Services (IHSS) provider wages obtained from the Case Management Information and Payrolling System (CMIPS).
- Information regarding the removal of a child from a CalFresh HH obtained from the Child and Family Well-Being or Foster Care system.
- Information that a HH member received substantial lottery or gambling winnings obtained from a gaming entity data match.

Information that is considered VUR may or may not result in a mid-period action after the information is reviewed. If it is determined that no action will be taken mid-period, send a No-Change NOA to the HH and follow up at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

Information cannot become VUR when additional information is provided at a later date. For example, a HH reports an income increase (under IRT) over the phone but does not provide additional details during the call. The HH later sends their paystubs, this information does not become VUR. In this situation, send a No-Change NOA to the HH and follow up at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

5. Voluntary Mid-Period Reports

When a voluntary report is made by the HH, determine if the report will result in an increase or a decrease to the HH's benefits. Do not act on voluntary mid-period reports that will result in a decrease or termination of the HH's benefits unless the information is VUR. Take action on voluntary reports that will result in an increase in the HH's benefits, with a few exceptions.

Changes must be effective the month following when the HH reports a change. Review and process changes within 10 days after the date the change was reported. If the case requires additional verification, process the change within 10 days after the verification is received. If the HH fails to provide the required verifications within 10 days but submitted them later, the timeframe for taking action on the change begins when the verifications are received, process the change and issue the updated benefit amount the month following when the verifications were received.

When a mid-period report is received but not acted on because it will result in a decrease in the HH's benefits:

- Document clearly in the case record the reason for not taking action.
- Send the HH a No-Change NOA.
- Ensure the NOA reminds the HH that they must report the information at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

When processing the next SAR 7 or RE, ensure the information is reported, if still applicable, and resolve any inconsistencies or discrepancies. Take action after the information is verified and document all actions in the case file.

As a reminder, HH's certified with income between 131 and 200 percent of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL) do not have a mandatory income reporting requirement because they have already reported income over 130 percent at application and met their mandatory IRT reporting requirement.

6. Verification Requirements for Voluntary Income Changes

A voluntary mid-period income change that results in an increase to the HH's benefits requires verification when the income change is:

- More than $50 and the income change will result in an increase in benefits.
- $50 or less and the income source has changed.

The HH must be informed in writing of any additional verification requirements and that failure to provide verification within the specified date will result in no change to their benefits.

If the income amount has changed by $50 or less and the income source has not changed, do not verify income changes unless the information is incomplete, inaccurate, inconsistent, or outdated (older than 60 days).

See table below for detailed guidance on verification requirements.

If verification is…	then…
provided,	benefits will be evaluated to take effect the following month after the report is made.
not provided within the requested timeframe,	send a No-Change NOA.
provided after the requested timeframe,	benefits will be re-evaluated to take effect the following month after the verification is received. See section 7 – Supplements above for further guidance.

Note: If the HH reports an income change of $50 or less and this change is over the HH's IRT, then it becomes a mandatory mid-period report and verification must be requested to determine ongoing eligibility.

See below for examples of reported changes that result in an increase in benefits.

Example 1	
Scenario	HH reports on April 10th that work hours were reduced to 35 hours a week. As a result, income has decreased by $100. The change will result in an increase in benefits.
Outcome	Send a Request for Verification (CW 2200) requesting income verification and allow 10 days to provide. **If the HH provides the required verification…** / **then…** within 10 days, / act on the change. Do not issue supplements for current or prior months. after 10 days, / evaluate benefits effective the first of the following month that the verification was provided. Do not issue supplements for current or prior months. If the HH does not provide verification, send the HH a No-Change NOA.

Example 2	
Scenario	HH reports on April 10th that work hours were reduced to 35 hours a week. The employer has not changed, and income is decreased by $40. The change will result in an increase in benefits.
Outcome	Verification of the income is not required; the amount is less than $50 and the income source has not changed. Process the change within 10 days to reflect an increase in the benefit allotment in May. Do not issue a supplement for April.

Example 3	
Scenario	HH reports on April 27th that work hours were reduced to 35 hours a week. Income has decreased by $40. The change will result in an increase in benefits.
Outcome	Verification of the income is not required; the amount is less than $50 and the income source has not changed. The increase must be effective for May, as it is the following month when the change was reported. Issue a supplement for May no later than May 10th. Do not issue a supplement for April.

Example 4	
Scenario	HH voluntarily reports a change in HH composition that will result in an increase in benefits.
Outcome	Send the HH a CW 2200 requesting verification of the new HH members' income and other mandatory verifications and allow 10 days to provide.

	<table><tr><th>If the HH provides the required verification…</th><th>then…</th></tr><tr><td>within 10 days,</td><td>act on the change to add the HH member effective the following month the report was received. Do not issue supplements for current or prior months.</td></tr><tr><td>after 10 days,</td><td>evaluate benefits effective the first of the following month that the verification was provided. Do not issue supplements for current or prior months.</td></tr></table> If the HH does not provide verification, send the HH a No-Change NOA.

7. Supplements

A supplement is an additional issuance of benefits that ensures the HH's total allotment for the month is accurate. Supplements must not be issued for the report month or months prior to the change report.

When a change that increases benefits requires verification, the HH must submit the verification within 10 days. If the verifications are submitted timely, process the change from the date it was reported, issue the increased benefits with the HH's next regular monthly benefit allotment date.

If the HH fails to provide the required verifications within 10 days but submitted them later, the timeframe for taking action on the change begins when the verifications are received, process the change and issue the updated benefit amount the month following when the verifications were received.

If the change is processed too late in the month to increase the HH's next monthly benefit allotment, issue the increased benefits no later than the 10th day of the month that the increased benefit amount is to be issued.

Reminder: Do not issue supplements for the report month or for any months prior to the change report. See examples below of change reports that result in a supplemental issuance.

Example 1	
Scenario	HH reports and verifies a $51 decrease of income on October 28th. The change will result in an increase in benefits.
Outcome	Increase the benefit allotment beginning with the November benefit month. Do not issue a supplement for October. Issue the HH a supplement to their November benefits by November 10th.

Example 2	
Scenario	HH received their monthly benefit on the 1st of the month. The weekly hours decreased to 30 hours a week resulting in income decreasing on September 1st by $200 a month. The HH does not submit the verifications of this change until November 28th. This change will result in an increase in CalFresh benefits.

Outcome	Process the change within 10 days of the verifications being received. Do not issue a supplement for September, October, or November. The increase in benefits is effective in December; issue a supplement by December 10th.

See example below of a change report that does not result in a supplemental issuance.

Example 3	
Scenario	HH received their monthly benefit on the 1st of the month. The HH reported their weekly hours decreased to 30 hours a week resulting in income decreasing effective September 1st by $200 a month. The HH submitted the requested income verifications of this change on September 8th. This change will result in an increase in CalFresh benefits.
Outcome	Process the change within 10 days of the verifications being received. Do not issue a supplement for September. The increase in benefits is effective in October. Do not issue a supplement.

8. PA CalFresh (PACF) Cases

When PA benefits such as CalWORKs, CAPI, or General Relief are recalculated mid-period, take action on the CalFresh case to be effective the next regular monthly benefit allotment. If the result is a decrease in benefits the effective date must allow for a timely notice.
Refer to the table below for actions to take on PACF cases.

If the reported changes result in…	then CalFresh must…
a change to the PA benefits,	act on the change regardless of the impact on benefits.
no change to the PA benefits,	only act on the change if it results in a benefit increase, unless the information is VUR.

9. Report of Reduction in ABAWD Work Hours

ABAWDs must report when their work hours drop below 20 hours per week, or 80 hours averaged month within 10 days of the date the ABAWD becomes aware of the change. When an ABAWD reports a reduction in work hours, determine if the ABAWD meets any of the time limit exemptions.

If the ABAWD has exhausted their three full countable months of benefits in their fixed 36-month period, terminate benefits at the end of the month in which timely and adequate notice can be provided. Further guidance regarding ABAWDs can be referenced in Section 63-904.

10. Unclear Information

Unclear information received mid-period is information reported about a HH's circumstances in which a determination on the continued eligibility or benefit amount cannot be made. Unclear information may potentially be considered VUR but needs additional information to act on the change appropriately.

When information is reported that is typically considered VUR but is not sufficient to take action. The information would then be considered unclear, because additional information is needed to act on the change.

Follow up if the unclear information received meets the following criteria:

- Is less than 60 days old from the current month's benefit; and
- Indicates the HH may have failed to report information at initial application, SAR 7, RE, or a mandatory mid-period change.

If information reported meets the criteria for unclear information, then send the HH a CW 2200 and allow the HH 10 days to respond. See detailed guidance below on required actions after the CW 2200 is sent.

If the HH…	then…
responds and clarifies the information,	determine if: 1. The information and/or verification is a mandatory mid-period requirement. For example, income over IRT, a drop in work hours for ABAWDs, substantial lottery/gambling winnings, or VUR. • Take action regardless of the impact to the HH's benefits. 2. The change would result in an increase or decrease to the HH's benefits. • Evaluate the impact on the HH's benefits and act only if the result is an increase in benefits. Document all actions in the case record and send the HH the appropriate NOA.
does not respond within 10 days or refuses to provide verification,	discontinue the case. Send the HH a timely and adequate NOA with information that explains the reason for the action.
does not meet the criteria for unclear information,	do not act on the information and do not request verification until the HH's next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first. Send a No-Change NOA.

11. Address Changes

Review a voluntary mid-period report made by the HH with a change of address or an institution, for example, a Drug or Alcohol Treatment Center (DATC) reports that a HH moved out of the location. Determine the impact on shelter costs. Shelter costs must not be verified, unless they are questionable. Do not disregard a change in shelter cost related to the address change. When a change of address is reported mid-period that does not include the updated shelter cost, send a CW 2200 to the HH and allow 10 days for them to respond.

Refer to the table below for required actions.

If the HH…	then…
provides updates shelter costs,	re-evaluate benefits with timely notice.
does not respond to the request,	end date the existing shelter expense and re-evaluate benefits without the deduction, with timely notice.
Provides the updated shelter cost at any time, after the 10 days,	re-evaluate benefits with timely notice.

12. Significantly Conflicting Unclear Information

Significantly conflicting unclear information applies when information received mid-period about a HH is greatly conflicting with the information used to determine eligibility for initial applications under normal processing and expedited services, and RE. Follow up if there is unclear information that appears to be significantly conflicting with the HH's circumstances that were used to determine eligibility at initial application or RE.

See detailed guidance below on required actions for significantly conflicting unclear information.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Example</th></tr>
<tr><td>Scenario</td><td>A HH was certified in January 2026 with no earned income and later obtains information from a third-party source four months into the certification period indicating the HH had earned income of $1200 during the initial certification month.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Outcome</td><td>Send the HH a CW 2200 requesting employment and pay information from January 1, 2026 to clarify the discrepancy and verify the income.
<table>
<tr><th>If the HH does…</th><th>then…</th></tr>
<tr><td>not provide verification,</td><td>discontinue the case due to failure to provide.</td></tr>
<tr><td>provide verification and a discrepancy is verified from the information used to determine eligibility previously,</td><td>process the information and review for an overissuance as appropriate. Send the appropriate NOA.</td></tr>
<tr><td>provide verification and no discrepancy is verified,</td><td>send a No-Change NOA.</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
</table>

13. Disqualified Recipient Database Matches

Action must be taken on Recipient IEVS (R-IEVS) database matches received mid-period regardless of the impact on the HH's benefits. Do not hold unclear information regardless of when the information was reported. Take immediate action to pursue verification of positive matches when one is received mid-period from the database.

The disqualified recipient database match includes but is not limited to Fleeing Felon Match (FFM), California Youth Authority (CYA) Match, and NPM.

For further guidance on R-IEVS data matches reference CFPG 63-118 and Self-Sufficiency Services Processing Guide – Income and Eligibility Verification System (IEVS).

14. Multiple Mid-Period Changes

When a HH reports multiple changes at once, each change must be evaluated individually and apply the applicable policy to each change.

Take action on mid-period reports that are mandatory mid period reports and reports considered VUR. If a report is not a mandatory mid-period report or VUR and causes the HH's benefits to decrease while another report would cause an increase, only act on the report that would result in a benefit increase. Document the report that would cause a decrease in the case record and follow up at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

See an example with detailed guidance below on required actions for multiple mid-period changes.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Example</th><th></th></tr>
<tr><td>Scenario</td><td>A HH reports adding two new HH member's mid-period: a newborn and the parent of the newborn.</td><td></td></tr>
<tr><td>Outcome</td><td>Evaluate whether adding the newborn would result in an increase or decrease in the HH's benefits.

<table><tr><th>If adding the newborn would result in…</th><th>then…</th></tr><tr><td>an increase in benefits,</td><td>send the HH a CW 2200 requesting verification, if applicable, and take action to add the newborn.</td></tr><tr><td>a decrease in benefits,</td><td>send the HH a No-Change NOA. Document the change in the case record and follow up at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.</td></tr></table>
After the impact of the first report is known, evaluate the impact of the second report.

If adding the newborn would cause an increase in benefits and adding the parent would cause a decrease in benefits, only add the newborn to the case mid-period. Add the parent of the newborn at the next SAR 7 or RE, whichever comes first.

Note: If the HH does not respond to the CW 2200 when a new HH member is reported mid-period, send a No-Change NOA because adding a HH member mid-period is not a mandatory mid-period report.</td><td></td></tr>
</table>

<u>Other Program Impacts</u>:
No Impact.

References:
Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) 272.1, 272.2, 272.17, 273.8, 273.9, 273.10, 273.11, 273.12, 273.13, and 273.18.
All County Letter (ACL) 12-25, 12-25E, 12-59, 13-08, 13-17, 13-26, 13-80, 15-42, 17-41, 18-20, 19-33, 19-86, 19-93, 20-132, 21-25, 21-101, 21-101E, 24-47, and 25-93.
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-58-13, I-58-13E, and I-58-25.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 08/31/2029.

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services